

6.3 UNIVERSAL HOUSING DESIGN

A dwelling of universal design incorporates elements that are ‘designed in’ from the beginning, thus not requiring subsequent modification or adaptation through the lifecycle of occupants.

This section is to be read in conjunction with the *Livable Housing Design Guidelines* produced by Livable Housing Australia.

Objectives

- (a) To increase the supply of universal housing.
- (b) To ensure a suitable proportion of dwellings include universal design features to accommodate the changing needs of occupants over their lifetimes.
- (c) To promote sustainable development by extending the usability of a dwelling to meet ‘whole of life’ needs of the community. To ensure that residential accommodation includes universal design features as best practice.

Controls

- (a) All dwellings in any new medium or high density residential accommodation are to incorporate the universal design features as outlined below (modelled on the *Livable Housing Design Guidelines Silver Level*):
 - (i) A safe and continuous and step free path of travel from the street entrance and/or parking area to a dwelling entrance that is level;
 - (ii) At least one level entrance into the dwelling;
 - (iii) Internal doors and corridor widths that facilitate comfortable and unimpeded movement between spaces;
 - (iv) A toilet on the ground (or entry) level that provides easy access;
 - (v) A bathroom that contains a hobless (step-free) shower recess;
 - (vi) Reinforced walls around the toilet, shower and bath to support the safe installation of grab rails at a later date;
 - (vii) A continuous handrail on one side of any stairway where there is a rise of more than one metre; and
 - (viii) Stairways are designed to reduce the likelihood of injury and also enable future adaptation.
- (b) All universally designed dwellings must be clearly identified on the submitted DA plans. The incorporation of Gold and Platinum Level design features is strongly supported.